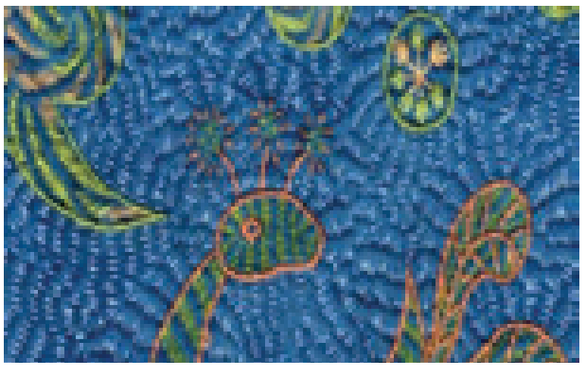


Figure 9.31 Kantha Embroidery

End Use

Kanthas were largely used as quilts. It is offered to special guests to sit or sleep on it. It was conferred to the bride and groom. It is also used to wrap valuables and gifts. Other uses of Kantha are bags which are used for keeping money and also used as book cover. Nowadays, Kantha embroidery is done on a single layer of white or coloured fabric base using contemporary motifs. Other products made with Kantha embroidery are stoles, dupattas, saris, and suit materials.

DO YOU KNOW?

Origin of Kantha embroidery.

Kantha is one of the oldest forms of embroidery that originated in West Bengal, India. Its origins can be traced back to the ancient pre Vedic ages. Kantha embroidery was found in Krishnadas Kaviraj's 500 year old book, Chaitanya Charitamrita.



9.5.4 Kathi Embroidery

Region

Kathi Embroidery, Kathibharat or Kathipa style of embroidery is practiced by the Kathi community tribal women of Gujarat. Black colour fabric is used as the base fabric. Stitched Kathipa style of embroidery is otherwise known as 'heer'.

Technique

Repeating patterns of six to eight-pointed stars, triangles and squares are arranged to form a beautiful design. Outlining is done with darning stitches and the fillings are covered with herringbone stitches. Mirrors are attached with buttonhole stitches to form squares and triangles.

Motifs

Motifs such as humans, animals and birds along with landscape forms are used in this embroidery. Bold motifs with mirrors create a colourful depiction in dark blue, orange, purple, indigo, black, deep red with little tints of yellow and green.

Style of Embroidery

Embossed designs are done all over the fabric. Geometric patterns are created between borders constructing chequered forms. Long stitches along with herringbone stitches and contrasting colours define the design vocabulary of Kathibharat. Small mirrors are stitched to add beauty to the embroidery. The stitches in triangles run in parallel to the warp and weft creating an interesting effect. Single colour silk floss with light and dark shades is often used.

End Use

The traditional attire of Kathi women become an intrinsic part of costumes worn by both rural and urban women

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